

Victor Rangel

Senior Economist | Causal Inference, Applied Economics & Data Science

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Professional Profile

Economist with a master's degree in Public Policy from Insper and experience at the intersection of causal inference, applied economics, and data science. Builds decision-oriented analyses from Brazilian administrative and market data using R, Python, SQL, and Stata. Research spans public policy, regulation, digital finance, political behavior, stock returns, and language models, with peer-reviewed publications and applied projects. Translates complex methods into clear analytical products, courses, dashboards, and policy recommendations.

Selected Professional Experience

Founder and Content Creator 2022–Present
Econometria Fácil Brazil

- Founded an educational project focused on econometrics, causal inference, and data analysis, reaching more than 200,000 followers.
- Columnist for *Folha de S.Paulo*, writing about evidence, public policy, data, and public debate.
- Designs courses and hands-on workshops in R, Python, Stata, causal inference, applied econometrics, and quantitative research workflows.

Master's-Level Research Assistant 2024–2025
Insper São Paulo, SP

- Worked on health economics and public policy evaluation projects, applying causal inference and panel-data methods and re-estimating empirical findings with modern difference-in-differences estimators.

Research Assistant 2023
FGV IBRE – Brazilian Institute of Economics Rio de Janeiro, RJ

- Developed the research design, assembled data, and implemented causal inference models for an econometric project evaluating infrastructure policies for Brazil's National Department of Transport Infrastructure (DNIT).

Data Scientist 2023
Senac – National Department Rio de Janeiro, RJ

- Integrated RAIS and CAGED administrative records with real-time job-posting data for a national labor-market analysis.
- Built predictive models to support decisions on educational offerings and demand for workforce training.

Senior Data Scientist 2021–2023
Sovos Compliance, LLC São Paulo, SP

- Led development of an automated tax-document processing system using NLP and machine learning.
- Architected AWS ETL pipelines with version control and CI/CD, collaborating with international teams to analyze regulatory and legislative documents.

Consultant 2020–2023
Downstream Advisors, Inc. Dallas, TX / Remote

- Developed market-intelligence solutions for oil and gas companies, including automated data collection, interactive dashboards, and spatial analysis for logistics and expansion decisions.

Education & Credentials

Master's Degree in Public Policy 2024–2026
Insper São Paulo, SP

Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations ADEPT Dec 13, 2025
MITx Online, Massachusetts Institute of Technology Verified credential

Graduate-Level Econometrics Course, Non-Degree Student 2021
Federal University of Espírito Santo Vitória, ES

Bachelor's Degree in Economics 2015–2020
FUCAPE Business School Vitória, ES

Selected Research & Publications

The Difference of Different Difference-in-Differences: Evidence from Health Economics Applications
Master's thesis, Professional Master's Program in Public Policy, Insper. Advisors: Cristine Pinto and Pedro H. C. Sant'Anna. Reassesses difference-in-differences applications in health economics and compares conventional TWFE estimators with estimators robust to treatment-effect heterogeneity.

2026

Environmental Enforcement and Abnormal Stock Returns: Causal Evidence from Brazil
Forthcoming in Brazilian Review of Finance; accepted at the 26th Brazilian Finance Meeting. Uses a causal research design to estimate the effects of environmental enforcement on abnormal stock returns in Brazil.

2026

Masking the Identification Problem: How Time Aggregation Manufactures Cross-Country Evidence—A Comment on Tausk & Spira (2025), BMC Public Health
Forthcoming in Journal of Comments and Replications in Economics. Shows how time aggregation can produce misleading cross-country comparative evidence and obscure identification problems in applied public health research.

2026

From Association to Explanation: Strengthening Research Design and Causal Reasoning in Accounting Scholarship
Forthcoming in Advances in Scientific and Applied Accounting. Discusses how accounting studies can move from associational evidence to causal explanations through research design, identification strategies, and greater clarity in inference.

2026

Regulatory Simplification, Formalization, and Local Economic Activity: Evidence from Brazil
Estimates how local regulatory simplification affects firm formalization and municipal economic activity.

Submitted

Economic Conditions and Voting Behavior
Public Choice. Examines how local economic conditions shape voting choices, linking economic performance, local shocks, and political behavior.

2025

Assessing Political Bias and Value Misalignment in Generative Artificial Intelligence
Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization. Tests whether generative AI systems express political preferences or value profiles that differ from those of various user groups.

2025

Natural Disasters and Financial Technology Adoption
Economics Letters. Studies whether exposure to natural disasters changes demand for digital financial services and accelerates fintech adoption.

2025

Government, Taxation and Economic Complexity
Applied Economics Letters. Investigates how government activity and tax structures relate to the economic complexity of countries and regions.

2024

More Human than Human: Measuring ChatGPT Political Bias
Public Choice. Measures the political orientation of ChatGPT responses and compares the model's results with patterns observed in human survey data.

2024

Bonus for Firearms Seizures and Police Performance
Economics Letters. Evaluates whether bonuses for firearm seizures affect police behavior and public-safety indicators.

2022

Economic Complexity and Corporate Governance
Applied Economics Letters. Explores the relationship between the sophistication of local economies and firm-level corporate-governance practices.

2022

Tools & Methods

Econometrics	Causal inference, randomized evaluation design, modern DiD, RDD, IV, synthetic control, panel data, time series, and quasi-experimental research designs.
Programming	Python, R, SQL, Stata; Pandas, scikit-learn, tidyverse, fixest, NLTK; Git, CI/CD, and automation.
Data & ML	ETL, AWS, NLP, LLMs, supervised learning, web scraping, data visualization, dashboards, and geospatial analysis.
Communication	Technical writing, policy briefs, applied teaching, documentation, presentations, and translation of quantitative results into actionable insights.